JJJ-A-711d
OCTOBER 1, 1957
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. JJJ-A-00711c(AGR-AMS)
March 22, 1957 and
Fed. Spec. JJJ-A-711b
January 22, 1942

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ASPARAGUS, CANNED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Styles and types of pack. — Unless otherwise specified, canned asparagus shall be "unpeeled" and shall be of the following styles and applicable types of pack as specified (see 6.1):

Style I.—Spears (or stalks)

(a) Green

(b) Green-tipped and white

Style II.—Tips

(a) Green

(b) Green-tipped and white

Style III.—Points

(a) Green

(b) Green-tipped and white

Style IV.—Cut spears (or cut stalks)

(If cut in lengths of 1¼ inches or less, the product shall contain an average of not less than 15 percent, by count, of heads; if cut in length of more than 1¼ inches, the product shall contain an average of not less than 20 percent, by count, of heads.)

(a) Green

(b) Green-tipped and white

1.1.1 *Dietetic packs.*—If dietetic packs of any of the styles and applicable types are desired, canned asparagus shall be specified as "dietetic" packs together with appropriate qualifications. (See 6.1.)

1.2 Size of spears, tips, and points.—Canned asparagus of these styles shall be of the following single size or blended sizes as specified (see 6.1).

1.2.1 *Singles sizes:*

Small—approximately $^{6}/_{16}$ inch diameter.

Medium—$^{6}/_{16}$ inch to $^{8}/_{16}$ inch diameter.

Large—$^{8}/_{16}$ inch to $^{10}/_{16}$ inch diameter.

Extra large (or Mammoth)—$^{10}/_{16}$ inch to $^{13}/_{16}$ inch diameter.

Colossal—$^{13}/_{16}$ inch to 1 inch in diameter.

Giant—1 inch and over in diameter.

1.2.2 *Blend of sizes.*

1.2.2.1 A mixture of two adjacent single sizes as specified.

1.2.2.2 A mixture of three adjacent single sizes as specified.

1.3 Grades.—Canned asparagus shall be of the following grades, as specified (see 6.1):

Fancy (Grade A)

Standard (Grade C)

441883/57/No. 103

FSC 8915 and 8940

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2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP–B–585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.

PPP–B–621—Boxes; Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP–B–636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–L–1497 — Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items.

MIL–P–1501—Packaging and Packing of Canned Subsistence Items, Overseas Shipment.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications.—The following publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus.

Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products.

(Single copies of the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus and applicable Regulations may be obtained without charge from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D. C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.—Canned asparagus shall be prepared from clean, sound, succulent asparagus and, unless specified otherwise, shall be of the latest season's pack.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act.—All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.3 Drained weight.—Drained weights of canned asparagus shall average not less than the drained weights specified in tables I, II, and III for the applicable styles and in accordance with 4.2.4.

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TABLE I.—*Minimum drained weight for style I, spears (or stalks)*

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style I, spears (or stalks)			
	Small, medium, large sizes; and blends of these sizes		Extra large, colossal, giant, or any blends including these sizes	
	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white
	Ounces	*Ounces*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*
12 Z	7½	8	7¼	7¾
13½ Z glass	8	8¾	7½	8¼
No. 300	8¾	9½	8	9
No. 300 x 409	9	9¾	8¼	9¼
No. 300 cylinder	11	----	10½	----
No. 1 tall	9¾	10¾	9¼	10½
No. 303	9¾	10¾	9¼	10½
No. 303 glass	9¾	10¾	9¼	10½
No. 2	12¼	13½	11¾	12¾
No. 2½	17¾	19½	17¼	18½
No. 2½ glass	17½	19¼	17	18¼
No. 603 x 408	39	43	38	41

TABLE II.—*Minimum drained weight for style II, tips; style III, points*

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style II, tips; style III, points			
	Small, medium, large sizes; and blends of these sizes		Extra large, colossal, giant, or any blends including these sizes	
	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white	(a) Green	(b) Green tipped and white
	Ounces	*Ounces*	*Ounces*	*Ounces*
8 oz. tall	5	5¼	5	5¼
8 oz. glass	5	5¼	5	5¼
No. 1 picnic	6¼	7	6	6½

3.4 Determination of styles, types, sizes, drained weights.—Unless otherwise specified, the determination of styles, types, sizes, grades, and drained weights of canned asparagus shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus (and lot inspection and certification tolerances applicable thereto) in effect on the date of the invitation for bids.

3.4.1 *Fancy (grade A).*—Canned asparagus of this grade shall be practically free from defects, shall possess a good character, shall possess a good flavor; and, within the limits prescribed in the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Asparagus, shall possess a clear or fairly clear liquor and shall possess a good color or a fairly good color.

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TABLE III.—*Minimum drained weight for style IV, cut spears (or cut stalks)*

Container size or designation (metal, unless otherwise stated)	Style IV, cut spears (or cut stalks)	
	(a) Green	(b) Green-tipped and white
	Ounces	*Ounces*
8 oz. tall	4¾	5
8 oz. glass	4¾	5
No. 1 picnic	6	6½
12 Z	7¼	7¾
No. 300	8½	9
No. 300 x 409	8¾	9¼
No. 300 cylinder	----	----
No. 1 tall	9¼	10¼
No. 303	9¼	10¼
No. 303 glass	9¼	10¼
No. 2	11¾	12¾
No. 2½	16¾	18½
No. 2½ glass	16¾	18½
No. 603 x 408	38	42
No. 10	60¼	64½

3.4.2 *Standard (grade C).*—Canned asparagus of this grade shall possess a fairly clear liquor, shall possess a fairly good color, shall be fairly free from defects, shall possess a fairly good character, and shall possess a fairly good flavor.

3.5 Workmanship. — Canned asparagus shall be processed under sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. The product shall be sufficiently processed by heat to assure preservation in hermetically-sealed containers, either tin or glass, as specified. Containers shall be sound and clean. Cans shall be free from rust and serious dents and the ends shall be flat or concave.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling.—Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.*—Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, and/or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 *Factory inspection.*—The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 *Final inspection.*—Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.4 and 6.5).

4.2.4 *USDA Certificate of Quality and Condition.* — When specified by the procuring agency the contractor shall furnish a U. S. Department of Agriculture Certificate of Quality and Condition as outlined in procurement documents (see 6.1).

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.*—Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

The definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

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5.1 **Packaging.**—The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2 as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.*—Cans shall be packaged in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–1501.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—Unless otherwise specified commercial packaging is acceptable.

5.2 **Packing.**—The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1, 5.2.2, or 5.2.3 as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Cans shall be packed in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–1501.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—The cans of the product, arranged as specified in Military Specification MIL–P–1501, shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting fiberboard, nailed wood, or wire-bound wood box, constructed and closed in accordance with type I or II, class 1, of Federal Specification PPP–B–636; class 1, style 4 or 4½, for type 2 load, of Federal Specification PPP–B–621; or style 2, 2A, or 3, class 1 use, for type 2 load, of Federal Specification PPP–B–585, respectively. The flaps of the fiberboard container shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed, applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of stitching one set of flaps prior to packing and sealing the other flaps with adhesive. When flaps are stitched, the stitches shall be distributed so as to fasten all flaps securely together over the entire area of contact between the inner and outer flaps and to prevent lifting of free edges and corners of the outer flaps.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—The packaged product shall be packed in containers which are acceptable to common carrier for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

5.3 **Labeling and marking.**

5.3.1 *Civilian agencies.*

5.3.1.1 *Unit containers.*—Any commercial labeling, or additional labeling as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 *Shipping containers.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the product, quantity and size of packages in container as defined by the contract or order under which the shipment is made, the name of the contractor, the number of the contract or order, the month and year of processing, and other pertinent information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Cans.*—Cans of the product shall be labeled in accordance with Military Specification MIL–L–1497.

5.3.2.2 *Shipping containers.* — Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Ordering data.** — Procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) The style and type of pack, size, and grade of product desired.

(*b*) Size and kind of packaging required, or levels of packaging as may be applicable.

(*c*) Level of packing as may be applicable.

(*d*) If "dietetic packs" are desired, the procurement documents should so specify.

(*e*) If USDA Certificate of Quality and Condition is desired the procurement documents should so specify.

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6.2 This specification does not include all blends of sizes or types of canned asparagus that are commercially available but is intended to cover the products that are normally suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.3 If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.4 **Contractor's inspection.**—The Contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.5 **Destination inspection.**—When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—Q M
Navy—S MC
Air Force.

☆ U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1957

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PLATE NO. 15419 (BACK)

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)*

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.

QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED

DOLLAR AMOUNT
$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426

REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE

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